

Two Decisions, One Story



Grade 3 • Mathematics
NC.3.OA.8

Represent and solve two-step stories.



What will a strong explanation show?

1. A model or equation that fits the quantities.
2. Accurate calculation with appropriate units.
3. A check that makes the answer reasonable.



Watch the reasoning

The art club has 4 packs of 3 cards and then uses 2 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

First $4 \times 3 = 12$. Then $12 - 2 = 10$.



Build a second model together

The community center has 9 packs of 3 cards and then receives 4 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Discuss: What should the first step find?



Your turn • 1

The reading group has 3 packs of 5 cards and then uses 2 cards.
How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Represent → solve → explain → check



Your turn • 2

The design team has 4 packs of 5 cards and then receives 5 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Represent → solve → explain → check



Your turn • 3

The reading group has 3 packs of 7 cards and then uses 3 cards.
How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Represent → solve → explain → check



Your turn • 4

The library team has 3 packs of 2 cards and then receives 6 more cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Represent → solve → explain → check



Exit question • Explain independently

The design team has 5 packs of 3 cards and then uses 5 cards. How many cards are there now? Label both steps.

Include a check. What would you teach someone else?



Teacher review and next steps

1. 13

Exit: 10

2. 25

Use the worked PDF key and slide notes to discuss methods. Revisit the earliest unclear step before adding more practice.

3. 18

4. 12

